according to Shiite belief, cannot make mistakes. In this context, it should be stated that the power of the Jewish lobby in the United States is not what it used to be.

In his Cairo speech, Obama said that no country was entitled to determine which country had the right to acquire nuclear weapons. But a nuclear Iran would trigger a nuclear arms race in the Middle East, which was contrary to the interests of the United States. This meant that the United States was afraid, not of a nuclear Iran, but of a nuclear Middle East. In other words, the United States seemed likely to accept Iranian hegemony in the Middle East, which was of great concern to moderate Sunni Arab states and, of course, to Israel.

The Obama administration was examining alternatives that would prevent the next stage of regional nuclearization and was looking for ways to curb proliferation, from Pakistan, with its unstable regime, to the rogue state of North Korea and to China and Russia. In the interest of reaching a consensus with Europe on this issue, the administration tried to define a red line that would be the lowest common denominator accepted: that is, that a Western response would come only after a nuclear or other nonconventional attack on Israel.

Another idea that was considered was the German-Japanese model of a two-month threshold for acquiring a bomb. According to this model, in order to reach an agreement or understanding with Iran, Iran would be allowed to advance to the point of being two months away from a bomb. Of course, such a deal would not solve the problem of the arms race throughout the entire region.

At the end of the day, toward the end of Obama's tenure, there was no chance of any intelligence picture motivating the administration to take action against Iran. The tendency was to believe that there was still time and that the hour had not yet come for action. This would be the approach until Iran carried out a nuclear test, after which the administration would adopt an approach that would try to persuade the Iranians not to repeat it.

Another American stance derived from the following logic:

- There was a connection between Iran's march toward nuclear weapons and the Israeli-Palestinian conflict.
- If the Israeli-Palestinian conflict was resolved, it would be difficult for Iran to attain nuclear weapons in the resulting atmosphere of